

The Shepherd

Avril Coleridge-Taylor

The Shepherd

William Blake (1757 – 1827)
from *Song of Innocence* (1789)

Avril Coleridge-Taylor (1903 – 1998)
arr. Zoë Birtwhistle for The Sheffield Chorale (Christmas 2025)

Expressivo **poco rit.** **a tempo**

Soprano

Alto

Tenor

Bass

How sweet is the Shep - herd's sweet

How sweet is the Shep - herd's sweet

p

p

sempre sostenuto e legato

5

p

From morn to the

From the morn to the eve - ning he strays;

lot: to the eve - ning he strays;

lot: From the morn to the eve - ning he

9

mp

eve - ning he strays; He shall

mp

He shall fol - low his

mp

He shall fol - low his

mp

strays; He shall

13

mf

fol - low his sheep all the day, And his

mf

sheep, He shall fol - low his sheep all the day, And his

mf

sheep all the day, And his

mf

fol - low his sheep all the day, all the day, And his

17

f

And his tongue — shall be filled with praise.

f

— And his tongue — filled with praise. —

f

tongue shall be filled — with — praise. —

f

tongue shall be filled with praise.

21

rit. **a tempo** *p*

For he

p

For he

rit. **a tempo** *p*

25

hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

p hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

p hears the lambs' call And he hears the

mp

8va

29

p And he hears the ewes' ten - der re -

And he hears the ewes' ten - der re -

p He is watch - ful while

hears the ewes' ten - der re - ply; watch - ful while

p And he hears the ewes' ten - der re - ply;

mp And he hears the ewes' ten - der re - ply;

p ewes' ten - der re - ply; He is watch - ful while

loco

33

- ply;

For they know when their

they are in peace

For they know when their

Shep - herd is

For they know when their

Shep - herd is nigh,

they are in peace

For they know when their

cresc.

37

Shep - herd is nigh,

Shep - herd is

For they know when their

Shep - herd is

nigh,

For they know when their

Shep - herd is

For they know when their

Shep - herd is

Shep - herd is nigh,

their Shep - herd is

8va

loco

dim.

41 *> pp* , Lento rit. ,

The score consists of five staves. The first four staves are vocal parts, each starting with a piano (*pp*) dynamic and a 'nigh.' marking. The fifth staff is the piano accompaniment, which begins in measure 41 with a piano (*pp*) dynamic. In measure 44, the tempo is marked 'Lento' and 'rit.' (ritardando). The piano part features complex chordal textures and melodic lines in both hands.

nigh. _____

nigh. _____

nigh. _____

nigh. _____

pp *pp* *pp* *pp*

Lento rit. ,